

8-WEEK FITNESS PLAN

Indian Vegetarian Fat-Loss, Lean Muscle, Strength & Visible Abs

Affordable - practical - progressive - consistency-focused

Built for someone with gym experience who wants to restart strongly and follow a realistic 2-month routine.

Primary goal

Reduce body fat while maintaining or gaining lean muscle.

Training style

4 mandatory strength days + 1 optional capacity day, abs 3x/week.

Diet style

Affordable vegetarian Indian foods: soya, dal, curd, milk, paneer/tofu, chana.

Realistic result

Visible improvement in waist, strength, discipline, and ab definition; not a fake overnight six-pack promise.

Important note

This plan is educational fitness guidance for a generally healthy adult. If you have pain, injury, diabetes, kidney disease, heart issues, eating-disorder history, or any medical condition, get clearance from a qualified doctor before changing training or diet. Because your height, weight, age, sex, and current body-fat level were not provided, calorie targets are given as accurate formulas plus practical starting ranges.

Use this PDF daily for 8 weeks. Log your workouts, hit protein, walk more, sleep well, and review every Sunday.

1. QUICK START: WHAT TO DO FROM TOMORROW

The plan works through four levers: a small calorie deficit, high vegetarian protein, progressive strength training, and repeatable habits. Do not chase extreme dieting. The goal is to look leaner, perform better, and build consistency you can continue after 8 weeks.

Protein

1.6-2.0 g per kg bodyweight daily. Example: 70 kg = 112-140 g/day.

Calories

Start at estimated maintenance minus 300-500 kcal. Adjust every 2 weeks.

Training

4 mandatory gym days weekly. 5th day is optional at first, recommended later.

Cardio/steps

2-3 zone-2 sessions weekly plus 7,000-10,000 daily steps.

Abs

Train abs 3x/week with progressive overload; fat loss reveals them.

Sleep

7-9 hours. Poor sleep increases hunger and reduces performance.

8-week realistic expectation

- A good fat-loss pace is 0.4-0.8% of bodyweight per week. Faster is not always better because strength and muscle retention can suffer.
- In 2 months, many people can lose about 2-5 kg fat and 2-6 cm from the waist if adherence is high. More is possible if starting body fat is high, but it is not guaranteed.
- Upper abs may become clearer if you are already near a lean body-fat range. A full six-pack may require more than 8 weeks depending on starting body fat and genetics.
- Strength can improve through better technique, consistency, and progressive overload even during fat loss, but avoid maxing out every week.

2. DIET TARGETS: CALORIES, PROTEIN, WATER

Set your own starting calories

Because exact body details were not provided, use this simple method. Weigh yourself in the morning 3-4 times per week and use the weekly average. Start with the calorie range below for 14 days, then adjust using the weekly check-in rules near the end of this PDF.

Bodyweight	Protein target	Fat-loss calorie starting range	Notes
55-60 kg	90-120 g/day	1,650-1,900 kcal/day	Use upper end if active or strength drops.
61-70 kg	100-140 g/day	1,850-2,200 kcal/day	Most lifters do well around 2,000-2,150.
71-80 kg	115-160 g/day	2,050-2,450 kcal/day	Reduce rice/roti first if fat loss stalls.
81-90 kg	130-180 g/day	2,300-2,750 kcal/day	Higher bodyweight needs more protein and steps.
Formula	1.6-2.0 g/kg	Maintenance: 30-33 kcal/kg, then minus 300-500	Adjust, do not guess forever.

Macro priorities

- Protein: 25-40 g in 3-5 meals. This is the most important muscle-retention habit during fat loss.
- Carbs: keep them around workouts. Roti, rice, poha, oats, banana, potatoes, and fruit can improve gym performance when portions are controlled.
- Fats: do not remove completely. Use 2-3 teaspoons oil/ghee per day, plus limited peanuts/nuts. Too much oil silently adds calories.
- Fiber: 25-35 g/day from dal, chana, rajma, vegetables, fruit, oats, and salad.
- Water: 35-45 ml per kg bodyweight daily. Example: 70 kg = 2.5-3.2 L/day. Add more if you sweat heavily.
- Salt/electrolytes: do not go zero-salt. A little salt and lemon water before training can help pumps and performance, especially in hot weather.

3. AFFORDABLE INDIAN VEGETARIAN MEAL PLAN

Use this as your default training-day template. It lands around 2,000-2,250 kcal and 120-145 g protein if portions are followed. Smaller athletes can reduce 1 roti or rice. Larger athletes can add 1 roti, 250 ml milk, or extra dal/soya.

Meal	What to eat	Approx calories	Approx protein	Budget prep notes
Breakfast	2 besan cheela from 70 g besan + vegetables + 150 g curd. Add 250 ml toned milk if protein is low.	450-600	25-38 g	Use onion, tomato, spinach, carrot. Cook with minimal oil on non-stick tawa.
Lunch	2 rotis OR 1 cup cooked rice + 1.5 cups dal/rajma/chole + sabzi + salad + 100-150 g curd.	600-750	28-40 g	Cook dal thick. Add extra dal instead of extra rice when hungry.
Pre-workout	1 banana + black coffee/tea without sugar + 30 g roasted chana OR 40 g sattv drink.	180-260	6-12 g	Eat 45-90 min before gym. If training early, banana + water is enough.
Post-workout	50 g dry soya chunks cooked as sabzi/pulao + fruit OR 250 ml milk. Optional: whey if budget allows.	300-450	28-38 g	Boil soya 5-7 min, rinse, squeeze, then cook with masala.
Dinner	2 rotis + 100 g paneer/tofu OR 50 g dry soya OR 1.5 cups dal + 2 cups vegetables + salad.	500-650	30-45 g	Prefer soya/tofu/low-fat paneer when cutting. Keep oil measured.
Optional snack	Buttermilk, fruit, sprouts, roasted chana, curd, or cucumber/carrot salad.	100-250	5-18 g	Use only if it fits calories or prevents binge eating.

Rest-day adjustment

- Keep protein the same. Reduce calories by 100-200 by removing banana, reducing rice, or eating 1 fewer roti.
- Do not remove all carbs; recovery still needs energy. Keep vegetables, curd, dal, and water high.
- If hunger is high, add low-calorie volume: cucumber, carrot, lauki, cabbage, spinach, tomato soup, or salad with lemon.

4. AFFORDABLE VEGETARIAN PROTEIN SOURCES AND SWAPS

Protein food	Typical useful serving	Protein	Why use it	Cheaper/alternate option
Soya chunks	50 g dry	25-27 g	Best budget protein. Very high protein per rupee.	Tofu, low-fat paneer, dal + curd
Dal/lentils	1.5 cups cooked	16-22 g	Staple, filling, high fiber.	Mix moong, masoor, arhar, chana dal.
Rajma/chole	1.5 cups cooked	18-22 g	Cheap bulk prep; good carbs + protein.	Kala chana, lobia, matar.

Protein food	Typical useful serving	Protein	Why use it	Cheaper/alternate option
Curd/dahi	200 g	7-10 g	Gut-friendly, easy with lunch/dinner.	Buttermilk, toned milk.
Milk	250 ml	8 g	Simple add-on protein and calories.	Curd, soy milk if tolerated.
Paneer	100 g	18-22 g	Good protein but calorie dense if full-fat.	Use 2-3x/week; replace daily paneer with soya/tofu.
Tofu	150 g	18-24 g	Lower fat than paneer; good if available cheaply.	Soya chunks.
Roasted chana/sattu	40-50 g	8-12 g	Easy snack/pre-workout.	Sprouts, dal chilla.
Whey	1 scoop	22-25 g	Optional convenience, not required.	50 g soya chunks + 250 ml milk usually cheaper.

Vegetarian alternatives for common situations

- If you cannot eat soya daily: rotate dal, chana, rajma, tofu, curd, milk, paneer, sprouts, and besan cheela.
- If you are lactose intolerant: use tofu, soya chunks, dal, chana, rajma, sprouts, and lactose-free/soy milk if affordable.
- If paneer is too expensive: use it once or twice weekly; make soya or dal the daily protein base.
- If you use whey: treat it as convenience, not magic. Buy only after protein from food is consistent.
- If you eat eggs despite being vegetarian at home: they can be used, but this plan is written without eggs.

5. WEEKLY GROCERY LIST AND MONTHLY COST

Food group	Weekly quantity for 1 person	Budget choice	Approx monthly cost
Soya chunks	350-500 g	Bulk packet	Rs. 250-400
Dals/lentils	800 g-1.2 kg	Moong/masoor/arhar/chedar dal mix	Rs. 500-900
Chana/rajma/lobia	500-800 g	Buy dry, soak overnight	Rs. 250-600
Milk/curd	4-6 L milk or homemade curd	Toned milk; set curd at home	Rs. 900-1,600
Paneer/tofu	250-500 g	Homemade paneer or local tofu	Rs. 400-1,200
Carb staples	Atta/rice/oats/poha/dalia as needed	Use family staples first	Rs. 600-1,200
Vegetables/salad	4-6 kg	Seasonal sabzi, cucumber, carrot, spinach	Rs. 1,500-2,800
Fruits	Bananas + seasonal fruit	Banana, apple/guava/papaya by season	Rs. 800-1,600
Snacks	Roasted chana/sattu/peanuts	Avoid costly protein bars	Rs. 300-800
Oil/spices/misc.	Measured oil, masala, lemon	Use normal home spices	Rs. 300-700

Practical monthly total: about Rs. 5,000-8,000 if family staples like atta, rice, spices, and some vegetables are already shared at home. About Rs. 6,500-11,000 if you buy everything alone or add frequent paneer/whey. The cheapest high-protein foundation is soya + dal/chedar/rajma + curd/milk.

Simple meal-prep method

- Sunday or night before: soak chana/rajma, pressure-cook, and refrigerate for 2-3 days.
- Boil soya chunks, rinse, squeeze, and cook as dry masala. Store 2 servings.

- Make thick dal with less water so each serving has more protein and is easier to pack.
- Chop salad vegetables and keep roasted chana/sattu ready for pre-workout snacks.
- Measure cooking oil with a spoon. One extra tablespoon oil can add about 120 calories.

Foods to limit during the 8 weeks

- Deep-fried foods: samosa, pakora, bhatura, poori, chips, namkeen.
- Sugar calories: sweet tea/coffee, cold drinks, packaged juices, sweets, biscuits.
- Restaurant gravies and high-oil sabzi. They can destroy the calorie deficit quickly.
- Unlimited nuts, peanuts, peanut butter, and paneer. They are healthy but calorie dense.
- Alcohol if you drink; it worsens sleep, hunger, recovery, and calorie control.

6. 8-WEEK GYM SCHEDULE

The schedule is designed to rebuild consistency first, then increase capacity. Days 1-4 are mandatory. Day 5 is optional in weeks 1-2 and recommended from week 3 if recovery is good. If life is busy, do the mandatory days and keep walking.

Week	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun	Weekly focus
1	Upper Strength A	Lower Strength B + abs	20 min zone-2 + mobility	Push C	Pull D + abs	Optional walk + core	Rest	Restart. RPE 6-7. Leave 3 reps in reserve.
2	A	B + abs	20-25 min cardio	C	D + abs	Optional Legs/Capacity E light	Rest	Add reps before adding weight. Build routine.
3	A	B + abs	25 min cardio	C	D + abs	E	Rest	5th day if recovered. Steps +1,000/day.
4	A	B + abs	25 min cardio	C	D + abs	E or rest	Rest	Quality week. If sore/tired, reduce accessory sets 20%.
5	A heavier	B heavier + abs	25-30 min cardio	C	D + abs	E	Rest	Strength block. Add load to compounds if form is solid.
6	A	B + abs	30 min cardio	C	D + abs	E + 10 min incline	Rest	Progress reps/loads. Keep protein perfect.
7	A	B + abs	30-35 min cardio	C	D + abs	E	Rest	Hardest week. Isolation can be close to failure.
8	A	B + abs	30 min cardio	C	D + abs	E light or test reps	Rest	Consolidate. Take photos, waist, strength review.

Warm-up for every workout

- 5-8 minutes easy treadmill/cycle/rowing until warm, not tired.
- Dynamic mobility: arm circles, band pull-aparts, hip hinges, bodyweight squats, ankle rocks.
- For the first compound lift, do 2-4 ramp-up sets. Example for 60 kg bench: empty bar x10, 40 kg x6, 50 kg x3, then work sets.
- Do not stretch aggressively before heavy sets. Save long static stretching for after training or rest days.

7. WORKOUT TEMPLATES: EXERCISES, SETS, REPS, REST

Workout A - Upper Strength (Monday)

Exercise	Sets	Reps	Rest	Execution note
Barbell bench press	4	4-6	2-3 min	Shoulder blades back/down. Stop 1-2 reps before form breaks.
Pull-up or lat pulldown	4	6-8	2 min	Full stretch, chest up. Add weight only after clean reps.
Barbell row or chest-supported row	3	6-8	2 min	Neutral spine; row to lower ribs.
Overhead press	3	5-8	2 min	Brace glutes and abs. Avoid leaning back.
Incline dumbbell press	2-3	8-10	90 sec	Controlled lower, strong press.
Face pull	3	12-15	60 sec	Elbows high; squeeze rear delts.
Curl + triceps superset	2	10-12	60 sec	Optional if time is short.

Workout B - Lower Strength + Core (Tuesday)

Exercise	Sets	Reps	Rest	Execution note
Back squat or hack squat	4	4-6	2-3 min	Depth you can control. Knees track with toes.
Romanian deadlift	3	6-8	2 min	Hips back, soft knees, feel hamstrings.
Leg press	3	8-10	90 sec	Controlled, do not bounce at bottom.
Seated/lying leg curl	3	10-12	75 sec	Pause 1 second at contraction.
Calf raise	4	10-15	60 sec	Full stretch and hard squeeze.
Cable crunch	3	10-15	60 sec	Round spine, exhale hard, add weight over time.
Front plank	2	45-60 sec	45 sec	Ribs down, glutes tight.

Workout C - Push Hypertrophy (Thursday)

Exercise	Sets	Reps	Rest	Execution note
Incline DB press or machine press	3	8-12	90 sec	Use full range without shoulder pain.
Seated DB shoulder press	3	8-10	90 sec	Do not turn it into an incline press.
Cable/machine fly	3	12-15	60 sec	Stretch chest, squeeze, no ego weight.
Lateral raise	4	12-20	45-60 sec	Lead with elbows, controlled tempo.
Dips or push-ups	2	AMRAP leaving 1 rep	90 sec	Use assisted dips if needed.
Triceps pushdown	3	10-15	60 sec	Elbows pinned.
Overhead triceps extension	2	12-15	60 sec	Long head triceps focus.

Workout D - Pull Hypertrophy + Core (Friday)

Exercise	Sets	Reps	Rest	Execution note
Lat pulldown	4	8-12	90 sec	Pull elbows down; do not swing.
Seated cable row	3	8-12	90 sec	Chest tall, squeeze shoulder blades.
One-arm DB row or machine row	3	10-12	75 sec	Stretch at bottom, row to hip.
Rear delt fly	3	15-20	60 sec	Light weight, strict reps.
EZ curl/preacher curl	3	10-12	60 sec	No body swing.
Hammer curl	2	12-15	60 sec	Forearms and brachialis.
Hanging knee raise	3	8-15	60 sec	Curl pelvis upward; do not just swing legs.
Pallof press	2	12/side	45 sec	Anti-rotation for core stability.

Workout E - Legs + Capacity (Saturday; optional weeks 1-2)

Exercise	Sets	Reps	Rest	Execution note
Deadlift/trap-bar deadlift OR hip thrust	3	3-5 or 8-12	2-3 min	Choose deadlift if technique is solid; otherwise hip thrust.
Front squat, goblet squat, or hack squat	3	8-10	90 sec	Moderate load; quality reps.
Bulgarian split squat	3	8-12/leg	90 sec	Start light. This builds legs and conditioning.
Leg extension	2-3	12-15	60 sec	Controlled squeeze; knee-friendly range.
Calf raise	3	12-20	60 sec	Pause top and bottom.
Farmer walk or sled push	4	30-40 m	60-90 sec	Capacity finisher. Keep posture tall.
Incline treadmill/cycle	1	10-20 min	-	Zone 2. Skip if recovery is poor.

8. CARDIO, ABS, AND CAPACITY PROGRESSION

Cardio plan

Weeks	Zone-2 cardio	Steps	Optional intervals	Purpose
1-2	2 x 20-25 min	7,000-8,000/day	None	Restart without draining recovery.
3-4	2-3 x 25 min	8,000-9,000/day	None or 4 easy pickups	Increase calorie burn and work capacity.
5-6	3 x 25-30 min	8,500-10,000/day	1 session: 6 rounds 30 sec hard/90 sec easy	Performance and fat-loss support.
7-8	3 x 30-35 min	9,000-10,000/day	Only if recovery is good	Maintain deficit without extreme dieting.

Zone 2 means you can talk in short sentences but cannot sing. Incline treadmill, cycling, cross-trainer, rowing, or brisk outdoor walking are all fine. Do not turn every cardio session into punishment; cardio should support weight training, not ruin it.

Abs/core training

Day	Core work	Progression
Tuesday	Cable crunch 3 x 10-15 + plank 2 x 45-60 sec	When all sets hit top reps, add 1 plate or slow tempo.
Friday	Hanging knee raise 3 x 8-15 + Pallof press 2 x 12/side	First remove swing, then add reps, then harder variation.
Wednesday or Saturday	Reverse crunch 3 x 12-20 + side plank 2 x 30-45 sec/side	Control pelvis; make reps harder before adding volume.

- Train abs like other muscles: controlled reps, progressive overload, and recovery. Random 200-crunch finishers are less useful than 8-12 hard quality sets weekly.
- For visible abs, body-fat reduction matters more than endless ab exercises. You cannot spot-reduce belly fat.
- Use breathing: exhale hard, ribs down, pelvis slightly tucked. Feel abs, not hip flexors or lower back.

Gradual capacity increase

Week	Gym capacity target	What to increase
1	Finish 4 workouts feeling you could do more.	Technique, logging, sleep routine.
2	Same 4 workouts, optional light Saturday.	Add 1 rep to several sets.
3	Try 5th day if soreness is manageable.	Add one cardio session or +1,000 steps/day.
4	Stabilize. Do not force volume if joints ache.	Quality reps, form, mind-muscle connection.
5	Heavier compounds, steady accessories.	Add 2.5-5 kg to lifts that reached top reps.
6	Maintain 5 days if recovery good.	Add reps/sets only where performance is stable.
7	Peak week; highest effort, not reckless.	Isolation sets can go close to failure.
8	Consolidate and evaluate.	Hold strength while waist drops; plan next block.

9. STRENGTH PROGRESSION AND SAFE OVERLOAD

Double-progression rule

- Each exercise has a rep range. Example: bench press 4 sets of 4-6 reps.
- Keep the same weight until you can hit the top of the rep range for all sets with clean form and 1-2 reps in reserve.
- Then increase weight next time: upper-body barbell +2.5 kg total, lower-body barbell +5 kg total, dumbbells +1-2 kg each if available, machines +1 plate only if form stays clean.
- If you cannot reach the low end of the rep range after increasing weight, the jump was too big. Reduce slightly and rebuild.
- Do not grind ugly reps during fat loss. Technical failure on heavy compounds increases injury risk and ruins recovery.

Effort guide: RPE and reps in reserve

RPE	Reps in reserve	Use in this plan
6	About 4 reps left	Week 1 warm-up to consistency; easy practice sets.
7	About 3 reps left	Most early compound work.
8	About 2 reps left	Main working effort for weeks 3-6.

RPE	Reps in reserve	Use in this plan
9	About 1 rep left	Occasional final sets in week 7, mostly isolation/accessories.
10	No reps left	Avoid on compounds. Rarely needed.

Substitutions if equipment is busy

- Bench press -> dumbbell press, Smith press, or machine chest press.
- Back squat -> hack squat, leg press, goblet squat, or Smith squat.
- Barbell row -> chest-supported row, T-bar row, cable row, or machine row.
- Pull-up -> assisted pull-up or lat pulldown.
- Deadlift -> trap-bar deadlift, Romanian deadlift, or hip thrust.
- The movement pattern matters more than the exact machine. Keep records so progression remains trackable.

10. ABS AND FAT LOSS: WHY ABS MAY NOT SHOW YET

Common reasons after 3 years of training

- Body fat is still covering the abdominal muscles. Many lifters have strong abs but cannot see them until body fat is lower.
- Calories are not consistently controlled. Weekend eating, sugary tea, oil, snacks, and restaurant food can erase weekday effort.
- Protein is too low for a vegetarian diet, making muscle gain and fullness harder.
- Training lacks progression. Doing the same weights/reps for months maintains, but may not improve, physique.
- Abs are trained only with high-rep easy crunches instead of weighted/progressive movements.
- Sleep, stress, and low steps reduce recovery and make hunger harder to manage.
- Genetics and fat distribution matter. Some people lose belly fat later than face/arms/chest fat.

How body-fat reduction reveals abs

Abs become visible when abdominal muscle thickness is high enough and the fat layer over the stomach is low enough. Men often need roughly the low-to-mid teens body-fat range for clear abs; women typically need a higher healthy range. Exact numbers vary, so track waist, photos, and performance instead of obsessing over a body-fat calculator.

Best combination

- Weight training: preserves and builds muscle so you look athletic, not just smaller.
- Calorie deficit: removes fat. Without this, abs usually remain hidden.
- High protein: protects muscle, improves fullness, supports recovery.
- Cardio and steps: increase calorie expenditure without needing an extreme diet.
- Sleep/recovery: keeps hormones, hunger, and performance under control.
- Core training: builds ab muscles and improves bracing for squats, deadlifts, presses, and posture.

11. CONSISTENCY SYSTEM: HOW TO AVOID FALLING OFF

Daily routine

Time	Action	Why it matters
Morning	Drink water, 5 min sunlight/walk, weigh 3-4x/week, decide gym time.	Starts the day with control and feedback.
Breakfast	Protein meal: cheela/curd/milk/sprouts/oats option.	Prevents low-protein day from the start.

Time	Action	Why it matters
Afternoon	Pack roasted chana/sattu/banana; keep water bottle visible.	Stops random snacks and missed pre-workout fuel.
60-90 min pre-gym	Banana + chana/sattu; caffeine optional.	Better energy and pumps.
Gym	Do planned workout or minimum workout. Log sets immediately.	Consistency beats perfect programming.
Night	Dinner protein, prepare next day's food/gym bag, sleep routine.	Removes friction for tomorrow.

Minimum workout rule for low-motivation days

When motivation is low, your only job is to enter the gym and complete the minimum. You are allowed to leave after it. Most days you will continue once you start.

If you have...	Do this minimum
15 minutes	5 min warm-up + 2 sets of first compound + 2 sets of second movement.
25 minutes	Warm-up + first 3 exercises for 2 hard sets each + 5 min incline walk.
Home/no gym	3 rounds: push-ups, backpack rows, squats/lunges, plank. Then walk 20 min.
Very tired	Zone-2 walk 20-30 min + mobility. Resume lifting next day.

Habit-building rules

- Fixed schedule: train at the same time whenever possible. Treat it like a class, not a mood-based choice.
- Prepare the environment: gym bag packed, bottle filled, headphones ready, workout noted in phone.
- Never miss twice. One missed workout is life; two missed workouts becomes a pattern.
- Use an implementation intention: 'At 6:30 pm I will go to the gym and do Workout A.'
- Track visible proof: tick a calendar for gym, protein, steps, and sleep. You should see a chain building.
- Do not rely on motivation. Rely on your system: time, bag, pre-workout meal, written workout, minimum rule.

12. PROGRESS TRACKING AND WEEKLY CHECK-IN

Track these only

Metric	How often	Target
Body weight	3-4 mornings/week	Use weekly average, not one random day.
Waist at navel	Every Sunday	Aim gradual decrease, about 0.5-1.5 cm/week if starting fat is high.
Progress photos	Every 2 weeks	Same light, same pose, same time.
Workout log	Every set	Weights, reps, RPE. Beat reps or load over time.
Protein	Daily	Hit target at least 6 days/week.
Steps/cardio	Daily/weekly	Meet weekly average, not perfection every day.
Sleep	Daily	7-9 hours; consistent bedtime/wake time.

Sunday check-in decisions

- If weight average drops 0.4-0.8% per week and strength is stable: continue exactly.
- If weight drops more than 1% per week and workouts feel weak: add 100-150 kcal/day from carbs around training.
- If weight and waist do not move for 2 weeks: reduce 100-150 kcal/day or add 2,000 steps/day.
- If strength drops for 2+ sessions and sleep is poor: fix sleep before cutting more food.
- If joints ache or motivation crashes: reduce accessory sets by 20-30% for 1 week, keep protein and steps.

What to do if you miss a workout

- Do not punish yourself with double volume the next day.
- Resume the next planned workout within 24-48 hours. If needed, skip the optional Saturday day first.
- If you miss 1 day: shift the schedule forward. If you miss 2-3 days: complete the remaining mandatory workouts and restart normal schedule next Monday.
- If you miss a full week: repeat the previous week with 90% of the loads and rebuild momentum.

13. RECOVERY, SLEEP, AND PERFORMANCE NUTRITION

Sleep routine

- Target 7-9 hours. If that is impossible, keep wake time consistent and add a 20-minute nap when needed.
- Stop caffeine 7-8 hours before sleep. Late caffeine can hurt fat loss indirectly by worsening sleep and hunger.
- Keep phone away for the last 20-30 minutes or use grayscale/low brightness.
- A simple pre-sleep routine: shower, next-day food/gym bag, 5 minutes stretching/breathing, lights out.

Performance nutrition around workouts

Timing	Simple option	Why
2-3 hours before	Normal meal with roti/rice + dal/curd/soya + vegetables	Fuel and amino acids.
45-90 min before	Banana + roasted chana/sattu + water	Quick carbs, light protein, better training energy.
During	Water. Add pinch salt/lemon if sweating heavily.	Hydration and performance.
Within 2 hours after	Soya/dal/paneer/tofu/curd meal; whey optional	Muscle repair and daily protein target.

Optional supplements - not required

- Creatine monohydrate 3-5 g/day can support strength and is vegetarian-friendly, but buy only if budget allows. Water weight may increase slightly; this is normal.
- Whey protein is convenient, not mandatory. If expensive, use soya chunks, milk/curd, dal, chana, and tofu/paneer.

14. DAILY CHECKLIST AND 8-WEEK SUCCESS RULES

Daily checklist

Habit	Done?
Protein target hit: 1.6-2.0 g/kg or your chosen daily gram target	
Calories controlled; oil, snacks, sweets, and restaurant food tracked	
Workout completed OR minimum workout done	

Habit	Done?
7,000-10,000 steps or planned cardio completed	
2.5-3.5 L water, more if sweating	
7+ hours sleep plan started before midnight if possible	
Workout log updated: exercises, sets, reps, weights	

Rules for the full 8 weeks

- Be boring with meals. Repeat meals that work instead of searching for perfect recipes daily.
- Do not slash calories after one bad day. Return to the plan at the next meal.
- Prioritize compounds, then accessories, then cardio. Do not skip warm-up or sleep to add more exercises.
- Visible abs are a result of weeks of repeated basics: deficit, protein, lifting, steps, sleep, and patience.
- At the end of week 8, review: weight trend, waist, photos, strength log, consistency percentage. Then continue another 8-12 weeks if needed rather than crash dieting.

You do not need a perfect life to get leaner. You need a repeatable plan that survives normal life. Follow the schedule, hit protein, keep portions controlled, train progressively, walk daily, and check in every Sunday.